

DEPARTMENT OF DEFENSE INTELLIGENCE INFORMATION REPORT

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COUNTRY: USSR
SUBJECT: (U) Unidentified Flying Objects
SC NUMBER:
DATE OF INFORMATION: 10 Nov 67 - 10 Jan 68
PLACE AND DATE OF ACQ: MOSCOW, USSR
20 Dec 67, to 11 Jan 68
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12. ORIGINATOR: OUSATRA MOSCOW USSR
13. PREPARED BY: [REDACTED]
14. APPROVING AUTHORITY: MELVIN A. NIELSEN
COLONEL, USAF
DEFENSE ATTACHE

REC'D 60-3-30 JAN 1968

SUMMARY:

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Report includes information on Russian commission set to study Unidentified Flying Objects. Of particular interest is the fact that first the Russians publicised the commission, but now claim the commission has been disbanded.

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(U) In early November 1967 (exact date believed to be 10 Nov) Moscow TV presented a program on Unidentified Flying Objects. On 12 Nov 67, Reuters release in the U.K. press (believe article was in Daily Telegraph) reported the program.

(U) The essence of the TV program, and Reuters report based on the TV program, is that the Russians had recently set up a commission to study UFOs. The chairman of the Commission is retired SAF Major General A.P. STROLYAROV, a former Technical Services Officer. The group consisted of 18 astronomers and SAF officers plus 200 observers.

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2. [REDACTED] A day or two after the TV program, the Reuters correspondent went to see General STROLYAROV. The General was very polite, confirmed the information about the commission, the 18 astronomers and SAF officers and the 200 observers. In addition, he said five (5) positive sightings had been made.

4. [REDACTED] Approximately a week later the Reuters correspondent went back to see General STROLYAROV. However, this time the correspondent could not get past the General's secretary; was politely but firmly told the General was no longer available for interview.

5. [REDACTED] On 12 December 1967, the British Embassy was directed by London to further investigate the subject with a view to cooperating with the Russians in observation teams for UFOs.

6. [REDACTED] The Scientific Counselor of the British Embassy went to the State Committee for Science and Technology and inquired about the UFO Commission and the possibility of British-Russian cooperation in observation of UFOs. The British Counselor was politely received and the commission was freely discussed. The British were told they would receive a reply to their request about cooperation.

7. [REDACTED] The British did not receive an answer and did not pursue the subject. However, on 8 January 1968 while on a routine visit to the Soviet State Committee for Science and Technology, the British Scientific Counselor was told the following: The commission for investigating UFOs had been set up in response to a popular demand. The commission had met twice, but since there was insufficient information to sustain it the commission would be disbanded after the next meeting.

8. [REDACTED] The British Scientific Counselor believes the original announcement of the work of the commission on TV was an oversight on the part of the censors because the commission has not been reported or referred to anywhere else. He believes the commission has not been disbanded, but will continue under cover. This information was sent to London.

COMMENT: [REDACTED]

1. [REDACTED] The preceding information was given to RO by source. RO also read confidential British files on this subject. RO did not approach Reuters correspondent because of delicate position of source. RO was unable to find anyone in Moscow who saw TV program or read article in UK press.

2. [REDACTED] On 10 or 11 November 1967 the U.S. Science Attache received a telephone call from the Reuters correspondent and was asked if he had seen the TV program. When the Science Attache replied that he had not seen the program, the correspondent described it and asked the Science Attache if he thought the information was worth reporting. The Science Attache said yes. The Science Attache, like the RO, has not seen the UK press report. The U.S. Science Attache will receive two copies of this report and will forward one copy to the appropriate S & T Agency in Washington.